

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive v1.0

Executive Edition

This document consolidates Parts 1 through 8 into a single founder directive.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 1)

> NOTE: This is Part 1 of the Founder Directive.

Founder Directive

Everything in this document has already been decided by the founder.

It is **not** a proposal.

It is **not** brainstorming.

Your responsibility is to implement this vision faithfully.

You may improve architecture, performance, UX, security, maintainability, scalability, testing, accessibility, SEO, and developer experience.

You may **not** replace the vision.

If you believe another direction is technically better, document it separately, but preserve the founder's vision unless explicit approval is given.

Vision

ImmigrationClock exists to become **the world's most trusted platform for understanding U.S. immigration through official government information and structured intelligence.**

ImmigrationClock is not simply a website.

It is an Immigration Intelligence Platform.

The long-term objective is that whenever someone wants to understand anything related to U.S. immigration, their first instinct is:

> "Check ImmigrationClock."

What ImmigrationClock is NOT

- Not an immigration law firm.
- Not a political website.
- Not a sensational news website.

- Not an AI chatbot.
- Not a dashboard collection.
- Not a content farm.
- Not a scraper that republishes articles.

What ImmigrationClock IS

ImmigrationClock is an event-driven knowledge platform.

Its purpose is to organize immigration information into one connected knowledge graph.

Every page should help users answer four questions:

1. What changed?
2. Why does it matter?
3. Who is affected?
4. Where did this information come from?

Trust is the product.

Revenue is the consequence of trust.

Product Philosophy

The public platform is the foundation.

Professional intelligence products are a second layer.

Never sacrifice the public mission to optimize for enterprise revenue.

The public platform earns trust.

The professional platform monetizes that trust ethically.

Long-Term Evolution

Stage 1

Trusted Public Information Platform

Stage 2

Professional Immigration Intelligence

Stage 3

Personalized Immigration

Stage 4

AI grounded only in official and indexed ImmigrationClock data

Stage 5

Immigration Workspace

Stage 6

Global Immigration

Stage 7

Immigration Knowledge Graph

Stage 8

Developer APIs

Stage 9

Enterprise Intelligence

Stage 10

Government Intelligence Platform

Every architecture decision should make these future stages easier, not harder.

Home Page

The homepage is the daily front page of U.S. immigration.

It should immediately answer:

- What changed today?
- Why does it matter?
- Who is affected?
- What should I explore next?

The homepage should feel closer to Bloomberg or Our World in Data than a traditional dashboard.

Trust Principles

Truth before traffic.

Government sources before commentary.

Every statistic must have a traceable source.

AI may explain.

AI may summarize.

AI may never invent facts.

If uncertainty exists, communicate uncertainty.

Implementation Rule

Whenever you are unsure what to build next, ask:

"Will this make ImmigrationClock the world's most trusted immigration intelligence platform?"

If the answer is no, do not build it.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 2)

The Problem We Exist to Solve

The United States immigration system is one of the most complex public systems in the world. Information exists across dozens of agencies, press releases, datasets, court decisions, policy memoranda, and news stories.

People are forced to assemble their understanding from scattered sources.

ImmigrationClock exists to organize that information into a coherent, trustworthy knowledge system.

We are not trying to publish the most content.

We are trying to produce the clearest understanding.

Our Audience

We build for:

- Individuals navigating immigration.
- Families supporting loved ones.
- International students.
- Employers sponsoring talent.
- HR and global mobility teams.
- Immigration attorneys.
- Journalists.
- Researchers.
- Policymakers.
- Anyone who wants factual immigration information.

Every feature should clearly identify which audience it primarily serves.

The Four Pillars

1. Official Sources First

Whenever possible, information should originate from official government sources.

Examples include:

- USCIS
- Department of State
- DHS
- CBP
- ICE
- Department of Labor
- Federal Register
- Executive Orders
- Federal Courts
- Congress

Secondary reporting may provide context, but official records remain the source of truth whenever available.

2. Explain, Don't Amplify

ImmigrationClock should not compete with newspapers on speed.

Instead, it should explain:

- what happened,
- why it matters,
- who is affected,
- how it compares historically,
- and where the information originated.

3. Connect Information

Every important object should connect to related information.

Examples:

Employer → WARN Notices → H-1B History → Related News → Government Sources

Country → Embassy → Visa Information → Policy Changes → Travel Guidance

Visa Category → Official Guidance → Processing Trends → FAQs → Historical Timeline

The platform is a knowledge graph, not a collection of isolated pages.

4. Earn Daily Trust

Trust is earned through consistency.

Every page should display, where appropriate:

- Original source
- Last updated date
- Data-through date
- Methodology
- Confidence or classification
- Known limitations

Users should never have to wonder where information came from.

Product Evolution Principles

Every new feature should satisfy at least one of these goals:

- Improve understanding.
- Improve discoverability.
- Improve transparency.
- Improve historical context.
- Improve decision making.
- Improve trust.

Avoid features that exist only because competitors have them.

Product Decision Test

Before approving a feature, answer these questions:

1. Does this help someone understand immigration better?
2. Does this strengthen trust?
3. Does this connect users with official information?
4. Is it likely to remain valuable five years from now?

5. Would we proudly explain this feature to a journalist or researcher?

If the answer to most questions is no, reconsider the feature.

Closing Principle

ImmigrationClock should become known for one thing above all else:

When people need to understand U.S. immigration, they know they can rely on ImmigrationClock for clear, sourced, and connected information.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 3)

Product Vision

ImmigrationClock is designed to become the daily destination for understanding U.S. immigration.

The product should not feel like a dashboard.

It should feel like a living intelligence platform where every visitor immediately understands what has changed, why it matters, and where the information originated.

The Homepage

The homepage exists to answer one question:

"What changed today?"

Every major section must reinforce that objective.

Recommended order:

1. Breaking immigration developments
2. What Changed Today
3. Trending immigration topics
4. Government agency updates
5. Recently refreshed datasets
6. Upcoming immigration dates
7. Explore by visa
8. Explore by country
9. Explore by employer
10. Newsletter
11. Professional Intelligence

The homepage should encourage repeat visits every morning.

The What Changed Engine

This is the flagship feature.

It detects meaningful changes across official immigration sources and trusted datasets.

Each event should include:

- Headline
- Summary
- Why it matters
- Who is affected
- Effective date
- Source agency
- Original source URL
- Historical comparison
- Related visas
- Related employers
- Related countries
- Related pages

The system should distinguish between:

- New information
- Updated information
- Corrected information
- Historical revisions
- Announcements
- Data releases

Immigration News Explained With Data

ImmigrationClock does not compete with news organizations.

Instead, it explains news using structured government data.

Every explainer should answer:

- What happened?
- Why is it important?
- What official information supports it?

- What changed historically?
- What is still unknown?
- Where can readers verify the source?

Knowledge Graph

Every entity should connect to related entities.

Core entities include:

- Employers
- Countries
- Visa categories
- Government agencies
- Executive Orders
- Court cases
- Policies
- News events
- Datasets
- Alerts
- Topics

Relationships should be visible throughout the platform.

Country Intelligence

Every country page should include:

- Current immigration news
- Visa information
- Embassy updates
- Official announcements
- Related visas
- Historical timeline
- Frequently asked questions
- Links to government sources

Visa Intelligence

Every visa page becomes a living knowledge hub.

Suggested sections:

- Overview
- Latest changes
- Government guidance
- Processing trends
- Timeline
- Frequently asked questions
- Related employers
- Related countries
- Related news
- Related policies

Employer Intelligence

Employer pages should combine:

- Sponsorship history
- WARN notices
- Related news
- Historical trends
- Government filings
- Geographic information
- Related employers

Never imply that WARN notices identify immigration status unless official data supports that conclusion.

Search Philosophy

Search should understand people, not just keywords.

Users should be able to search:

- Countries
- Employers
- Visas
- Agencies
- Topics
- News
- Policies

- Court cases

The search experience should connect users with related information rather than isolated pages.

Product Goal

The product should become the place users visit every morning before reading immigration headlines elsewhere because ImmigrationClock provides the context those headlines often lack.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 4)

Technical Execution Philosophy

Your responsibility is not to maximize feature count.

Your responsibility is to maximize long-term trust, maintainability, and adaptability.

Every engineering decision should support the 10-year vision.

Event-Driven Architecture

ImmigrationClock revolves around structured immigration events.

An event may originate from:

- USCIS
- Department of State
- DHS
- CBP
- ICE
- Department of Labor
- Federal Register
- Executive Orders
- Federal Courts
- Congress
- Verified government datasets

Each event should include:

- Stable identifier
- Source agency
- Published date

- Effective date (if different)
- Data-through date (if applicable)
- Classification
- Severity
- Summary
- Related entities
- Original source URL
- Last verification timestamp

Events become the foundation for pages, timelines, alerts, newsletters, APIs, and AI.

AI Boundaries

AI assists.

Official data decides.

AI may:

- summarize
- explain
- compare
- organize
- answer questions using indexed ImmigrationClock knowledge

AI must never:

- invent policy
- fabricate statistics
- hide uncertainty
- replace official citations
- create unsupported legal conclusions

Every AI answer should reference the underlying source whenever possible.

Repository Principles

Organize the repository around domains rather than isolated pages.

Examples:

- events
- employers

- visas
- countries
- agencies
- datasets
- search
- alerts
- intelligence
- shared UI
- shared services

Avoid duplicated business logic.

Engineering Standards

Prefer:

- modular services
- reusable components
- strongly typed models
- automated testing
- documented interfaces
- predictable naming
- clear separation of concerns

Optimize for readability over cleverness.

Assume another engineer or AI agent will maintain this code years from now.

Security

Treat public trust as a security feature.

Protect:

- credentials
- user information
- API keys
- administrative actions

Never expose secrets in the repository.

Never assume external data is trustworthy without validation.

Data Freshness

Every major page should communicate:

- Source
- Last refreshed
- Data-through date
- Published date
- Methodology

Users should always know how current the information is.

Analytics

Measure:

- What users search for
- Which questions remain unanswered
- Which pages build trust
- Which features increase return visits

Do not optimize only for clicks.

Optimize for successful understanding.

Engineering Decision Framework

When choosing between two technical solutions ask:

1. Which option preserves trust?
2. Which option is easier to maintain?
3. Which option scales to millions of users?
4. Which option supports future knowledge graph growth?
5. Which option makes future AI assistance easier?

Document tradeoffs whenever the answer is not obvious.

Final Principle

Every pull request should leave ImmigrationClock more trustworthy than it was before.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 5)

Business Strategy and Long-Term Evolution

The Business Model

ImmigrationClock is built on a simple principle:

Public trust comes first.

Revenue is earned by creating additional value, not by restricting essential public information.

The public platform should remain the primary destination for understanding U.S. immigration.

Professional products should extend that value for organizations with more advanced needs.

Public Platform

The public experience should provide:

- Current immigration changes
- Historical context
- Government data
- Country pages
- Visa pages
- Employer pages
- Search
- News explained with data
- Methodology
- Free newsletter

The objective is to become the daily destination for immigration understanding.

Professional Intelligence

Professional products are designed for:

- Immigration law firms
- Corporate HR
- Global mobility teams

- Universities
- Journalists
- Researchers
- Government affairs teams

Potential capabilities include:

- Advanced employer intelligence
- Historical research
- Organization watchlists
- Team alerts
- Professional reports
- Data exports
- APIs
- Enterprise integrations

These products should never reduce the quality of the public experience.

Growth Philosophy

Growth should come from usefulness rather than promotion.

Primary growth channels:

- Search engines
- Newsworthy data
- Government-source explainers
- Newsletters
- Word of mouth
- Academic and media citations
- High-quality APIs

Avoid creating content solely for search rankings.

Every page should solve a real information problem.

Ten-Year Roadmap

Stage 1

Trusted public immigration information platform.

Stage 2

Professional immigration intelligence.

Stage 3

Personalized immigration experience.

Stage 4

Grounded AI assistant.

Stage 5

Immigration workspace.

Stage 6

Global immigration coverage.

Stage 7

Comprehensive immigration knowledge graph.

Stage 8

Developer platform and APIs.

Stage 9

Enterprise intelligence.

Stage 10

Trusted public-information technology company capable of expanding into additional government-information domains.

Each stage should build upon the previous one without abandoning the core mission.

Success Metrics

Success is not measured only by traffic.

Track:

- Trust
- Return visitors
- Newsletter engagement
- Search quality
- Citations
- User satisfaction
- Professional adoption
- Data quality
- Platform reliability

Long-term trust is a leading indicator of long-term business success.

Final Founder Principle

Whenever there is tension between increasing short-term revenue and preserving long-term trust:

Choose trust.

Trust compounds.

Trust becomes reputation.

Reputation becomes the company's greatest competitive advantage.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 6)

The Future of ImmigrationClock

The Long-Term Ambition

Do not think of ImmigrationClock as a website.

Think of it as the trusted operating system for immigration intelligence.

Software is temporary.

Trust, relationships, and knowledge endure.

Every architectural decision should strengthen those three assets.

The Immigration Knowledge Graph

The true product is not pages.

The true product is the network of relationships between immigration entities.

Examples:

Country ↔ Embassy ↔ Visa Category ↔ Government Agency ↔ Policy ↔ Executive Order ↔ Court Decision ↔ Employer ↔ WARN Notice ↔ Dataset ↔ News Event.

When a user visits any page, they should naturally discover the surrounding context.

Navigation should feel like exploring knowledge rather than browsing menus.

AI as an Interpreter

Artificial intelligence is not the destination.

AI is an interpreter sitting on top of verified ImmigrationClock knowledge.

Before answering a question, AI should identify:

- Relevant entities
- Related events
- Government sources
- Historical context
- Known uncertainty

Then produce a grounded explanation.

When evidence is incomplete, AI must clearly say so.

Product Expansion

Future capabilities may include:

- Personalized dashboards
- Saved topics
- Employer watchlists
- Country watchlists
- Daily intelligence briefings
- Enterprise APIs
- Research workspaces
- Historical comparisons
- Collaboration tools

Build today's architecture so these capabilities fit naturally without major rewrites.

Company Principles

ImmigrationClock succeeds when:

People understand immigration better.

Researchers trust the data.

Journalists cite the platform.

Professionals rely on it.

Government information becomes easier to understand.

Revenue follows because the platform consistently creates value.

Founder Expectations for Claude

You are expected to think beyond individual features.

Whenever implementing a change:

- Protect trust.
- Preserve the founder's vision.
- Improve architecture where appropriate.
- Leave the codebase cleaner than you found it.
- Document important tradeoffs.
- Avoid unnecessary complexity.
- Recommend improvements that strengthen the long-term platform.

Challenge implementation choices when needed.

Do not challenge the mission.

Definition of Success

The project is successful when ImmigrationClock becomes the first place people visit to understand U.S. immigration.

It is exceptional when people return every day because they know ImmigrationClock will explain what changed, why it matters, who is affected, and where the information came from.

That is the standard every feature should support.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 7)

User Experience Philosophy

ImmigrationClock is not designed for users to "browse."

It is designed for users to understand.

Every screen should reduce confusion and increase confidence.

First-Time Experience

Within ten seconds a first-time visitor should understand:

- What ImmigrationClock is.
- What changed today.
- Why it matters.
- Where the information came from.
- Where to go next.

Avoid overwhelming users with charts before they understand the story.

Lead with understanding, then provide depth.

Daily Experience

ImmigrationClock should become part of a user's daily routine.

Every visit should answer:

- What changed since my last visit?
- Which topics affect me?
- What deadlines are approaching?
- What official information was published?

The experience should reward returning users.

Newsroom Philosophy

ImmigrationClock is not a newsroom that competes on speed.

It competes on clarity.

Every important development should connect to:

- Official source
- Historical context
- Related visas
- Related employers
- Related countries
- Related datasets
- Frequently asked questions

The goal is understanding, not breaking news.

Search Philosophy

Search should behave like an intelligent guide.

When someone searches:

"H-1B"

They should discover:

- H-1B overview
- Latest updates
- Historical trends
- Top employers
- Government guidance
- Related court decisions
- Related news
- Related datasets

Search should encourage exploration.

Personalization

Future personalization should help users focus on what matters to them.

Examples:

- Follow countries
- Follow visa categories
- Follow employers
- Follow agencies
- Follow topics

Personalization should simplify the experience without creating information silos.

Accessibility

ImmigrationClock serves a global audience.

Design for:

- Mobile first
- Clear language
- High contrast
- Keyboard navigation
- Screen readers

- Slow internet connections
- International visitors

Accessibility is a product feature, not an afterthought.

User Trust

Every page should answer:

Can I trust this?

The interface should communicate trust through:

- Transparent sourcing
- Clear dates
- Neutral language
- Stable design
- Predictable navigation

Trust should be visible throughout the product.

Closing Principle

People should leave ImmigrationClock feeling more informed than when they arrived.

That feeling is the product.

ImmigrationClock Founder Directive (Part 8)

Claude Code Operating Rules

Your Role

You are the lead implementation partner for ImmigrationClock.

Your responsibility is to transform the founder's vision into production-quality software while preserving the principles defined in this Founder Directive.

You are expected to think proactively, identify risks, improve implementation details, and recommend better engineering approaches.

You are not expected to redefine the company's mission.

What You May Change

You may improve:

- Architecture
- Performance
- Security
- Accessibility
- Maintainability
- Scalability
- Testing
- Documentation
- Developer experience
- UX implementation
- Visual design consistency
- Internal APIs
- Data pipelines

When improving these areas, explain important tradeoffs.

What You Must Not Change

Do not change without explicit founder approval:

- Mission
- Vision
- Public-first philosophy
- Trust principles
- Editorial neutrality
- Official-source-first policy
- Long-term roadmap
- Product identity

If you believe a different direction is stronger, document your recommendation separately.

Engineering Workflow

Before implementing major work:

1. Understand the problem.
2. Review existing architecture.

3. Reuse before rebuilding.
4. Prefer simple solutions.
5. Add or update tests.
6. Document meaningful decisions.

Every significant feature should improve the overall platform.

Code Review Checklist

Before considering work complete, verify:

- Builds successfully
- Tests pass
- Accessibility maintained
- Mobile experience preserved
- Sources remain visible
- Data freshness displayed
- Existing routes not unintentionally broken
- SEO preserved or improved
- Performance not significantly degraded

Implementation Priority

Priority 1

Trust and data integrity

Priority 2

"What Changed" platform

Priority 3

Knowledge graph and navigation

Priority 4

Search and personalization

Priority 5

Professional intelligence

Priority 6

AI experiences

Every future enhancement should naturally build upon previous work.

Founder Expectation

When faced with multiple reasonable solutions, choose the one that:

- increases trust
- simplifies understanding
- reduces long-term maintenance
- strengthens the knowledge graph
- supports future evolution

Optimize for the next decade rather than the next sprint.

Final Founder Directive

Imagine ImmigrationClock ten years from now.

Build today's software so that future version is easier to achieve.

Every commit should move ImmigrationClock closer to becoming the world's most trusted immigration intelligence platform.

Protect that mission in every decision.